

Mistress of Choices

Urban Indian women today are on the threshold of economic independence ("Capital Woman", May 5). Along with professional excellence, she must have the wisdom and good sense to be a loving wife and an affectionate mother.

S. LAKSHMI, on e-mail

Growth Pangs

I would like to thank the magazine for bringing up the issue of teen suicides ("Teen Suicides", April 28). I strongly feel that the only solution to this problem is spirituality. Meditation and yoga will calm their troubled souls.

PRANJAL JOSHI, on e-mail

The story highlights the grim reality behind the facade of "Young India". What is worrying is that parents, in their zeal to push their kids, forget that their children are winners in their own right.

STUTI GOSWAMI, Guwahati

Failure to perform is the underlying cause of rising suicide cases among teenagers. The kind of syllabi being taught in schools today acts as a catalyst to the problem. It is important that the affected group i.e. the students and their parents be involved in the designing of the syllabus.

RAJEEV MAHAJAN, Baroda

My daughter has just entered her teenage. I must admit that I have started noticing quite a few of the symptoms narrated in the story. I am sure that through the advice given in the story, I would be in a

much better position to handle my child.

NUTAN THAKUR, Lucknow

A Dwarfed Presence

Manmohan Singh is the weakest prime minister India has ever had ("Downsizing Manmohan", April 28). In the first place, he was not elected by the people, but selected by the chairperson of a family owned private concern, the Congress. Despite Arjun Singh and Pranab Mukherjee challenging his

authority, he has still chosen to be silent.

N. DIVAKARAN, on e-mail

Arjun Singh has displayed moral bankruptcy by expressing such childish thoughts. He should not be in charge of the country's education system. He cannot teach anything good to the future generations of the country and is just not concerned about improving the quality of our education system.

HIMAL CHAND, Chandigarh

TAKING IT ON THE CHIN



If Tibet is an inalienable part of China as it claims, then Tibetan Buddhism should have been derived from Chinese Buddhism ("The Olympic Flame", May 5). It, however, has its roots in Indian Buddhism. If Indic civilisation had been politically more aggressive than it has chosen to be, then India has at least as good a case for laying claim on Tibet as China has, on cultural grounds.

ARVIND SHARMA, Montreal, Canada

It is high time China started caring about its international reputation by stopping atrocities on Tibetans and acceded to their just demands. In this era of globalisation, no country can afford to lose the goodwill of other countries.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, Dehradun

The decision by many world leaders to not attend the Olympic Games should be lauded. Perhaps this will pressure China into holding talks with the Dalai Lama.

INDU SHANKAR, on e-mail

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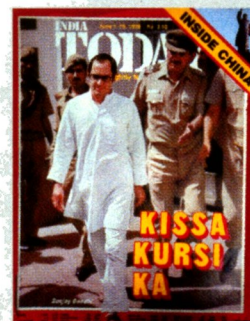
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Years Ago in India Today

JUNE 1-15, 1978



Of Censorship and Sex

Director Shyam Benegal has proved that art films can be successful at the box office while retaining their individuality. His views on censorship and film standards:

On the suggestion to amend the Cinematograph Act: Censorship is a necessary evil, but the political views of a regime should not be allowed to influence it.

On allowing kissing: There is no harm in allowing kissing in films if it is not vulgar.



Benegal

On sex scenes in films: Sex has a legitimate role to play. When kissing is not allowed, filmmakers resort to vulgarity.

On vulgarity in dance sequences: A lot of vulgarity came to films due to the attitude of the government.

On the role of films in sex education: In its garb, they are preaching pornography.

—R.S. Sethi